

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 6

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

072. Chapter 6 verse 1

VERSE 6.1

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

अनाश्रितः कर्मफलं कार्यं कर्म करोति यः ।

स संन्यासी च योगी च न निरग्निरन चाक्रियः ॥ १ ॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

anāśhritaḥ karma-phalaṁ kāryaṁ karma karoti yaḥ

sa sannyāsī cha yogī cha na niragnir na chākriyaḥ

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Lord said; anāśhritaḥ—not desiring; karma-phalam—results of actions; kāryam—obligatory; karma—work; karoti—perform; yaḥ—one who; saḥ—that person; sanyāsī—in the renounced order; cha—and; yogī—yogi; cha—and; na—not; niḥ—without; agniḥ—fire; na—not; cha—also; akriyaḥ—without activity

He who performs the prescribed duty without depending on the fruits of work is a sannyasi and a yogi, and not he who has merely ceased performing sacrifices such as Agnihotra yajna or abandoned bodily activities.

073. Chapter 6 verse 2

VERSE 6.2

यं संन्यासमिति प्राहुर्योगं तं विद्धि पाण्डव ।
न ह्यसंन्यस्तसङ्कल्पो योगी भवति कश्चन ॥ २ ॥

yam sannyāsam iti prāhur yogam tam viddhi pāṇḍava
na hyasannyasta-saṅkalpo yogī bhavati kaśhchana

yam—what; **sanyāsam**—renunciation; **iti**—thus; **prāhuḥ**—they say; **yogam**—yog; **tam**—that; **viddhi**—know; **pāṇḍava**—Arjun, the son of Pandu; **na**—not; **hi**—certainly; **asannyasta**—without giving up; **saṅkalpaḥ**—desire; **yogī**—a yogi; **bhavati**—becomes; **kaśhchana**—anyone

O Arjuna! That which is called sannyasa, know that to be yoga also; no one who has not given up desire can ever become a yogi.

074. Chapter 6 verses 3-4

VERSE 6.3

आरुरुक्षोर्मुनेर्योगं कर्म कारणमुच्यते ।
योगारूढस्य तस्यैव शमः कारणमुच्यते ॥३॥

ārurukṣhor muner yogam karma kāraṇam uchyate
yogārūḍhasya tasyaiva śamaḥ kāraṇam uchyate

ārurukṣhoḥ—a beginner; **muneh**—of a sage; **yogam**—Yog; **karma**—working without attachment; **kāraṇam**—the cause; **uchyate**—is said; **yoga ārūḍhasya**—of those who are elevated in Yog; **tasya**—their; **eva**—certainly; **śamaḥ**—meditation; **kāraṇam**—the cause; **uchyate**—is said

For the sage aspiring to ascend to yoga, action is said to be the means; and for the same sage enthroned in yoga serenity is called the means.

VERSE 6.4

यदा हि नेन्द्रियार्थेषु न कर्मस्वनुषज्जते ।
सर्वसङ्कल्पसंन्यासी योगारूढस्तदोच्यते ॥४॥

yadā hi nendriyārtheṣhu na karmasv-anuṣhajjate
sarva-saṅkalpa-sannyāsī yogārūḍhas tadochyate

yadā—when; **hi**—certainly; **na**—not; **indriya-artheṣhu**—for sense-objects; **na**—not; **karmasu**—to actions; **anuṣhajjate**—is attachment; **sarva-saṅkalpa**—all desires for the fruits of actions; **sannyāsī**—renouncer; **yoga-ārūḍhaḥ**—elevated in the science of Yog; **tadā**—at that time; **uchyate**—is said

When the sage feels no attachment for sense-objects and actions, renouncing the ego-centric will (samkalpa) then he is said to be enthroned in yoga.

075. Chapter 6 verses 5-6

VERSE 6.5

उद्धरेदात्मनात्मानं नात्मानमवसादयेत् ।
आत्मैव ह्यात्मनो बन्धुरात्मैव रिपुरात्मनः ॥५॥

uddhared ātmanātmānam nātmānam avasādayet
ātmaiva hyātmāno bandhur ātmaiva ripur ātmanah

uddharet—elevate; **ātmanā**—through the mind; **ātmānam**—the self; **na**—not; **ātmānam**—the self; **avasādayet**—degrade; **ātmā**—the mind; **eva**—certainly; **hi**—indeed; **ātmanah**—of the self; **bandhuḥ**—friend; **ātmā**—the mind; **eva**—certainly; **ripuḥ**—enemy; **ātmanah**—of the self

Let a man be lifted up by his own self; let him not lower himself; for he himself is his friend, and he himself is his enemy.

VERSE 6.6

बन्धुरात्मात्मनस्तस्य येनात्मैवात्मना जितः ।
अनात्मनस्तु शत्रुत्वे वर्ते तात्मैव शत्रुवत् ॥ ६ ॥

bandhur ātmātmanas tasya yenātmaivātmanā jitaḥ
anātmanas tu śhatrutve vartetātmaiva śhatru-vat

bandhuḥ—friend; **ātmā**—the mind; **ātmanaḥ**—for the person; **tasya**—of him; **yena**—by whom; **ātmā**—the mind; **eva**—certainly; **ātmanā**—for the person; **jitaḥ**—conquered; **anātmanaḥ**—of those with unconquered mind; **tu**—but; **śhatrutve**—for an enemy; **varteta**—remains; **ātmā**—the mind; **eva**—as; **śhatru-vat**—like an enemy

**For those who have conquered the mind, it is their friend.
For those who have failed to do so, the mind works like an
enemy.**

076. Chapter 6 verse 7

VERSE 6.7

जितात्मनः प्रशान्तस्य परमात्मा समाहितः ।
शीतोष्णसुखदुःखेषु तथा मानापमानयोः ॥ ७ ॥

jitātmanah praśhāntasya paramātmā samāhitah
śhītoṣṇa-sukha-duḥkheṣhu tathā mānāpamānayoh

jita-ātmanah—one who has conquered one's mind; **praśhāntasya**—of the peaceful; **parama-ātmā**—God; **samāhitah**—steadfast; **śhīta**—in cold; **uṣhṇa**—heat; **sukha**—happiness; **duḥkheṣhu**—in distress; **tathā**—also; **māna**—in honor; **apamānayoh**—and dishonor

The man who has subdued the mind and is full of peace experiences the Supreme Self under all conditions in heat and cold, pleasure and pain, honour and dishonour. (The mind of such a man experiences the Self under all conditions).

077. Chapter 6 verses 8-9

VERSE 6.8

ज्ञानविज्ञानतृप्तात्मा कूटस्थो विजितेन्द्रियः ।
युक्त इत्युच्यते योगी समलोष्टाश्मकाञ्चनः ॥ ८ ॥

jñāna-vijñāna-triptātmā kūṭa-stho vijitendriyaḥ
yukta ityuchyate yogī sama-loṣṭāśhma-kāñchanah

jñāna—knowledge; **vijñāna**—realized knowledge, wisdom from within; **tripta ātmā**—one fully satisfied; **kūṭa-sthaḥ**—undisturbed; **vijita-indriyaḥ**—one who has conquered the senses; **yuktaḥ**—one who is in constant communion with the Supreme; **iti**—thus; **uchyate**—is said; **yogī**—a yogi; **sama**—looks equally; **loṣṭra**—pebbles; **āśhma**—stone; **kāñchanah**—gold

The yogi who is satisfied with the knowledge of the Sastras and experience of the Self, who is immovable, who has conquered the senses, who look with an equal eye on mud, stone and gold, is said to be united or harmonised in yoga.

VERSE 6.9

सुहृन्मित्रार्युदासीनमध्यस्थद्वेष्यबन्धुषु ।
साधुष्वपि च पापेषु समबुद्धिर्विशिष्यते ॥९॥

suhṛin-mitrāryudāsīna-madhyastha-dveṣhya-bandhuṣhu
sādhuṣhvapi cha pāpeṣhu sama-buddhir viśhiṣhyate

su-hṛit—toward the well-wishers; **mitra**—friends; **ari**—enemies; **udāsīna**—neutral persons; **madhya-stha**—mediators; **dveṣhya**—the envious; **bandhuṣhu**—relatives; **sādhūṣhu**—pious; **api**—as well as; **cha**—and; **pāpeṣhu**—the sinners; **sama-buddhiḥ**—of impartial intellect; **viśhiṣhyate**—is distinguished

He who is equal-minded towards the good-hearted, friends, enemies, the indifferent, neutrals, haters, relations, towards the righteous and also the wicked, excels.

078. Chapter 6 verses 10-14

VERSE 6.10

योगी युञ्जीत सततमात्मानं रहसि स्थितः ।
एकाकी यतचित्तात्मा निराशीरपरिग्रहः ॥ 10 ॥

yogī yuñjīta satatam ātmānaṁ rahasi sthitaḥ
ekākī yata-chittātmā nirāśhīr aparigrahaḥ

yogī—a yogi; **yuñjīta**—should remain engaged in meditation; **satatam**—constantly; **ātmānam**—self; **rahasi**—in seclusion; **sthitaḥ**—remaining; **ekākī**—alone; **yata-chitta-ātmā**—with a controlled mind and body; **nirāśhīr**—free from desires; **aparigrahaḥ**—free from desires for possessions

Alone, stationed in a solitary place, self-controlled, free from desire, and not receiving anything from others, the yogi (Practising Dhyanayoga) should unite the mind with Atma.

शुचौ देशे प्रतिष्ठाप्य स्थिरमासनमात्मनः ।
नात्युच्छ्रितं नातिनीचं चैलाजिनकुशोत्तरम् ॥ 11 ॥
तत्रैकाग्रं मनः कृत्वा यतचित्तेन्द्रियक्रियः ।
उपविश्यासने युञ्ज्याद्योगमात्मविशुद्धये ॥ 12 ॥

śhuchau deśhe pratiṣṭhāpya sthiram āsanam ātmanah
nātyuchchhritam nāti-nīcham chailājina-kuśhottaram
tatraikāgram manah kṛitvā yata-chittendriya-kriyah
upaviśhyāsane yuñjyād yogam ātma-viśhuddhaye

śhuchau—in a clean; deśhe—place; pratiṣṭhāpya—having established;
sthiram—steadfast; āsanam—seat; ātmanah—his own; na—not; ati—too;
uchchhritam—high; na—not; ati—too; nīcham—low; chaila—cloth; ajina—a
deerskin; kuśha—kuśh grass; uttaram—one over the other; tatra—there; eka-
agram—one-pointed; manah—mind; kṛitvā—having made; yata-chitta—
controlling the mind; indriya—senses; kriyah—activities; upaviśhya—being
seated; āsane—on the seat; yuñjyāt yogam—should strive to practice yog; ātma
viśhuddhaye—for purification of the mind;

In a clean spot, a firm seat should be made, neither too high nor too low, and it should be covered by cloth, skin, and holy grass one over the other. There, being seated, having made the mind one-pointed, controlling the actions of the mind and the senses, let him practice Dhyana Yoga for self-purification.

समं कायशिरोग्रीवं धारयन्नचलं स्थिरः ।
सम्प्रेक्ष्य नासिकाग्रं स्वं दिशश्चानवलोकयन् ॥ 13 ॥
प्रशान्तात्मा विगतभीर्ब्रह्मचारिव्रते स्थितः ।
मनः संयम्य मच्चित्तो युक्त आसीत् मत्परः ॥ 14 ॥

samaṁ kāya-śhiro-grīvaṁ dhārayann achalaṁ sthiraḥ
samprekṣhya nāsikāgraṁ svaṁ diśhaśh chānavalokayan
praśhāntātmā vigata-bhīr brahmachāri-vrate sthitaḥ
manaḥ sanyamya mach-chitto yukta āsīta mat-parah

samam—straight; **kāya**—body; **śhiraḥ**—head; **grīvam**—neck; **dhārayan**—holding; **achalam**—unmoving; **sthiraḥ**—still; **samprekṣhya**—gazing; **nāsika-agram**—at the tip of the nose; **svam**—own; **diśhaḥ**—directions; **cha**—and; **anavalokayan**—not looking; **praśhānta**—serene; **ātmā**—mind; **vigata-bhīḥ**—fearless; **brahmachāri-vrate**—in the vow of celibacy; **sthitaḥ**—situated; **manaḥ**—mind; **sanyamya**—having controlled; **mat-chittaḥ**—meditate on me (Shree Krishna); **yuktaḥ**—engaged; **āsīta**—should sit; **mat-parah**—having me as the supreme goal

Let him firmly hold the body, head and neck erect, and gazing on the tip of his nose, without looking around, let him sit, serene and fearless, established in the vow of celibacy, self-controlled and balanced, thinking of Me as the Supreme goal.

079. Chapter 6 verse 15

VERSE 6.15

युञ्जन्नेवं सदात्मानं योगी नियतमानसः ।
शान्तिं निर्वाणपरमां मत्संस्थामधिगच्छति ॥ 15 ॥

yuñjann evaṁ sadātmānaṁ yogī niyata-mānasaḥ
śhāntim nirvāṇa-paramāṁ mat-sansthām adhigachchhati

yuñjan—keeping the mind absorbed in God; **evam**—thus; **sadā**—constantly; **ātmānam**—the mind; **yogī**—a yogi; **niyata-mānasaḥ**—one with a disciplined mind; **śhāntim**—peace; **nirvāṇa**—liberation from the material bondage; **paramāṁ**—supreme; **mat-sansthām**—abides in me; **adhigachchhati**—attains

Thus the self-controlled Yogi holding the mind in meditation on the Self, attains peace abiding in me which culminates in the highest bliss of liberation.

080. Chapter 6 verses 16-19

VERSE 6.16

नात्यश्नतस्तु योगो ऽस्ति न चैकान्तमनश्नतः ।
न चाति स्वप्नशीलस्य जाग्रतो नैव चार्जुन ॥ 16 ॥

nātyaśhnatastu yogo 'sti na chaikāntam anaśhnataḥ
na chāti-svapna-śhīlasya jāgrato naiva chārjuna

na—not; **ati**—too much; **aśhnataḥ**—one who eats; **tu**—however; **yogaḥ**—Yog; **asti**—there is; **na**—not; **cha**—and; **ekāntam**—at all; **anaśhnataḥ**—abstaining from eating; **na**—not; **cha**—and; **ati**—too much; **svapna-śhīlasya**—one who sleeps; **jāgrataḥ**—one who does not sleep enough; **na**—not; **eva**—certainly; **cha**—and; **arjuna**—Arjun

O Arjuna! Verily, yoga is not for one who eats too much or who does not eat at all, nor for him who sleeps too much or who does not sleep at all.

VERSE 6.17

युक्ताहारविहारस्य युक्तचेष्टस्य कर्मसु ।
युक्तस्वप्नावबोधस्य योगो भवति दुःखहा ॥ 17 ॥

yuktāhāra-vihārasya yukta-cheṣṭasya karmasu
yukta-svapnāvabodhasya yogo bhavati duḥkha-hā

yukta—moderate; **āhāra**—eating; **vihārasya**—recreation; **yukta cheṣṭasya**
karmasu—balanced in work; **yukta**—regulated; **svapna-avabodhasya**—sleep
and wakefulness; **yogaḥ**—Yog; **bhavati**—becomes; **duḥkha-hā**—the slayer of
sorrows

For him who is moderate in food and recreation, moderate in exertion in all actions, moderate in sleep and wakefulness, yoga destroys all pain and suffering (caused by birth and death).

VERSE 6.18

यदा विनियतं चित्तमात्मन्येवावतिष्ठते ।
निःस्पृहः सर्वकामेभ्यो युक्त इत्युच्यते तदा ॥ 18 ॥

yadā viniyatam chittam ātmanyevāvatishṭhate
niḥspṛihaḥ sarva-kāmebhyo yukta ityuchyate tadā

yadā—when; **viniyatam**—fully controlled; **chittam**—the mind; **ātmani**—of the self; **eva**—certainly; **avatishṭhate**—stays; **niḥspṛihaḥ**—free from cravings; **sarva**—all; **kāmebhyah**—for yearning of the senses; **yuktaḥ**—situated in perfect Yog; **iti**—thus; **uchyate**—is said; **tadā**—then

When the perfectly controlled mind rests in the Self free from longing for all enjoyments, then one is said to have attained yoga.

VERSE 6.19

यथा दीपो निवातस्थो नेङ्गते सोपमा स्मृता ।
योगिनो यतचित्तस्य युञ्जतो योगमात्मनः ॥ 19 ॥

yathā dīpo nivāta-stho neṅgate sopamā smṛitā
yogino yata-chittasya yuñjato yogam ātmanaḥ

yathā—as; **dīpaḥ**—a lamp; **nivāta-sthaḥ**—in a windless place; **na**—does not; **iṅgate**—flickers; **sā**—this; **upamā**—analogy; **smṛitā**—is considered; **yoginaḥ**—of a yogi; **yata-chittasya**—whose mind is disciplined; **yuñjataḥ**—steadily practicing; **yogam**—in meditation; **ātmanaḥ**—on the Supreme

Just as a lamp in a windless place does not flicker, so the disciplined mind of a yogi remains steady in meditation on the Supreme.

081. Chapter 6 verses 20-21

VERSE 6.20-23

यत्रोपरमते चित्तं निरुद्धं योगसेवया ।
यत्र चैवात्मनात्मानं पश्यन्नात्मनि तुष्यति ॥ 20 ॥
सुखमात्यन्तिकं यत्तद्बुद्धिग्राह्यमतीन्द्रियम् ।
वेत्ति यत्र न चैवायं स्थितश्चलति तत्त्वतः ॥ 21 ॥
यं लब्ध्वा चापरं लाभं मन्यते नाधिकं ततः ।
यस्मिन्स्थितो न दुःखेन गुरुणापि विचाल्यते ॥ 22 ॥
तं विद्याद् दुःखसंयोगवियोगं योगसंज्ञितम् ।
स निश्चयेन योक्तव्यो योगोऽनिर्विण्णचेतसा ॥ 23 ॥

yatroparamate chittaṁ niruddhaṁ yoga-sevayā
yatra chaivātmanātmānaṁ paśhyann ātmani tuṣhyati
sukham ātyantikaṁ yat tad buddhi-grāhyam atīndriyam
veti yatra na chaivāyaṁ sthitaśh chalati tattvataḥ
yaṁ labdhvā chāparaṁ lābhaṁ manyate nādhikaṁ tataḥ
yasmin sthito na duḥkhena guruṇāpi vichālyate
taṁ vidyād duḥkha-sanyoga-viyogaṁ yogasañjñitam
sa niśhchayena yuktavyo yogo 'nirviṇṇa-chetasā

yatra—when; uparamate—rejoice inner joy; chittam—the mind; niruddham—restrained; yoga-sevayā—by the practice of yog; yatra—when; cha—and; eva—certainly; ātmanā—through the purified mind; ātmānam—the soul; paśhyan—behold; ātmani—in the self; tuṣhyati—is satisfied; sukham—happiness; ātyantikam—limitless; yat—which; tat—that; buddhi—intellect; grāhyam—grasp; atīndriyam—transcending the senses; veti—knows; yatra—wherein; na—never; cha—and; eva—certainly; ayam—he; sthitaḥ—situated; chalati—deviates; tattvataḥ—Eternal Truth; yaṁ—which; labdhvā—having gained; cha

—and; **aparam**—any other; **lābham**—gain; **manyate**—considers; **na**—not; **adhikam**—greater; **tataḥ**—than that; **yasmin**—in which; **sthitah**—being situated; **na**—never; **duḥkhena**—by sorrow; **guruṇā**—(by) the greatest; **api**—even; **vichālyate**—is shaken; **tam**—that; **vidyāt**—you should know; **duḥkha-sanyoga-viyogam**—state of severance from union with misery; **yoga-sañjñitam**—is known as yog; **saḥ**—that; **niśchayena**—resolutely; **yoktavyaḥ**—should be practiced; **yogaḥ**—yog; **anirvinṇa-chetasā**—with an undeviating mind

Where the mind rests restrained by the practice of yoga, and where the self seeing the Self is delighted in the Self; and where established, the yogi knows that bliss which transcends the senses, which is understandable by the purified intellect only, and from the experience of Self does not even move; possessing which, he does not think any other gain greater than that; in which established he is not shaken even by great sorrow; that should be known by the term yoga, and that yoga which is free from sorrow should be attained by the undesponding and determined mind.

082. Chapter 6 verses 22-23

VERSE 6.20-23

यत्रोपरमते चित्तं निरुद्धं योगसेवया ।
यत्र चैवात्मनात्मानं पश्यन्नात्मनि तुष्यति ॥ 20 ॥
सुखमात्यन्तिकं यत्तद्बुद्धिग्राह्यमतीन्द्रियम् ।
वेत्ति यत्र न चैवायं स्थितश्चलति तत्त्वतः ॥ 21 ॥
यं लब्ध्वा चापरं लाभं मन्यते नाधिकं ततः ।
यस्मिन्स्थितो न दुःखेन गुरुणापि विचाल्यते ॥ 22 ॥
तं विद्याद् दुःखसंयोगवियोगं योगसंज्ञितम् ।
स निश्चयेन योक्तव्यो योगोऽनिर्विण्णचेतसा ॥ 23 ॥

yatroparamate chittam niruddham yoga-sevayā
yatra chaivātmanātmānam paśhyann ātmani tuṣhyati
sukham ātyantikam yat tad buddhi-grāhyam atīndriyam
veti yatra na chaivāyam sthitaśh chalati tattvataḥ
yam labdhvā chāparam lābham manyate nādhikam tataḥ
yasmin sthito na duḥkhena guruṇāpi vichālyate
tam vidyād duḥkha-sanyoga-viyogam yogasañjñitam
sa niśhchayena yuktavyo yogo 'nirvinṇa-chetasā

yatra—when; uparamate—rejoice inner joy; chittam—the mind; niruddham—restrained; yoga-sevayā—by the practice of yog; yatra—when; cha—and; eva—certainly; ātmanā—through the purified mind; ātmānam—the soul; paśhyan—behold; ātmani—in the self; tuṣhyati—is satisfied; sukham—happiness; ātyantikam—limitless; yat—which; tat—that; buddhi—intellect; grāhyam—grasp; atīndriyam—transcending the senses; veti—knows; yatra—wherein; na—never; cha—and; eva—certainly; ayam—he; sthitaḥ—situated; chalati—deviates; tattvataḥ—Eternal Truth; yam—which; labdhvā—having gained; cha

—and; **aparam**—any other; **lābham**—gain; **manyate**—considers; **na**—not; **adhikam**—greater; **tataḥ**—than that; **yasmin**—in which; **sthitah**—being situated; **na**—never; **duḥkhena**—by sorrow; **guruṇā**—(by) the greatest; **api**—even; **vichālyate**—is shaken; **tam**—that; **vidyāt**—you should know; **duḥkha-sanyoga-viyogam**—state of severance from union with misery; **yoga-sañjñitam**—is known as yog; **saḥ**—that; **niśchayena**—resolutely; **yoktavyaḥ**—should be practiced; **yogaḥ**—yog; **anirvinṇa-chetasā**—with an undeviating mind

Where the mind rests restrained by the practice of yoga, and where the self seeing the Self is delighted in the Self; and where established, the yogi knows that bliss which transcends the senses, which is understandable by the purified intellect only, and from the experience of Self does not even move; possessing which, he does not think any other gain greater than that; in which established he is not shaken even by great sorrow; that should be known by the term yoga, and that yoga which is free from sorrow should be attained by the undesponding and determined mind.

083. Chapter 6 verses 24-25

VERSE 6.24-25

सङ्कल्पप्रभवान्कामांस्त्यक्त्वा सर्वानशेषतः ।
मनसैवेन्द्रियग्रामं विनियम्य समन्ततः ॥ 24 ॥
शनैः शनैरुपरमेद्बुद्ध्या धृतिगृहीतया ।
आत्मसंस्थं मनः कृत्वा न किञ्चिदपि चिन्तयेत् ॥ 25 ॥

saṅkalpa-prabhavān kāmāns tyaktvā sarvān aśheṣhataḥ
manasaivendriya-grāmaṁ viniyamya samantataḥ
śhanaiḥ śhanair uparamed buddhyā dhṛiti-grihītayā
ātma-sanstham manah kṛitvā na kiñchid api chintayet

saṅkalpa—a resolve; **prabhavān**—born of; **kāmān**—desires; **tyaktvā**—having abandoned; **sarvān**—all; **aśheṣhataḥ**—completely; **manasā**—through the mind; **eva**—certainly; **indriya-grāmam**—the group of senses; **viniyamya**—restraining; **samantataḥ**—from all sides; **śhanaiḥ**—gradually; **śhanaiḥ**—gradually; **uparamet**—attain peace; **buddhyā**—by intellect; **dhṛiti-grihītayā**—achieved through determination of resolve that is in accordance with scriptures; **ātma-sanstham**—fixed in God; **manah**—mind; **kṛitvā**—having made; **na**—not; **kiñchit**—anything; **api**—even; **chintayet**—should think of

Having abandoned all desires born of the ego-centric will, having restrained the group of senses with mind from all sides, one should attain quietude slowly and slowly by the intellect held firmly. And then, fixing the mind in Atma, he should not think of anything else at all.

084. Chapter 6 verses 26-27

VERSE 6.26

यतो यतो निश्चरति मनश्चञ्चलमस्थिरम् ।
ततस्ततो नियम्यैतदात्मन्येव वशं नयेत् ॥ 26 ॥

yato yato niśhcharati manaśh chañchalam asthiram
tatas tato niyamyaitad ātmanyeva vaśham nayet

yataḥ yataḥ—whenever and wherever; **niśhcharati**—wanders; **manaḥ**—the mind; **chañchalam**—restless; **asthiram**—unsteady; **tataḥ tataḥ**—from there; **niyamyā**—having restrained; **etat**—this; **ātmani**—on God; **eva**—certainly; **vaśham**—control; **nayet**—should bring

Whenever and wherever the restless and unsteady mind wanders, one should bring it back and continually focus it on God.

VERSE 6.27

प्रशान्तमनसं ह्येनं योगिनं सुखमुत्तमम् ।
उपैति शान्तरजसं ब्रह्मभूतमकल्मषम् ॥ 27 ॥

praśhānta-manasaṁ hyenaṁ yoginaṁ sukham uttamam
upaiti śhānta-rajasaṁ brahma-bhūtam akalmaṣham

praśhānta—peaceful; **manasam**—mind; **hi**—certainly; **enam**—this; **yoginam**—yogi; **sukham uttamam**—the highest bliss; **upaiti**—attains; **śhānta-rajasaṁ**—whose passions are subdued; **brahma-bhūtam**—endowed with God-realization; **akalmaṣham**—without sin

Supreme Bliss comes to the yogi whose mind is completely tranquil and whose passions are quieted, who is free from stain and who has become one with Brahman.

085. Chapter 6 verses 28-29

VERSE 6.28

युञ्जन्नेवं सदात्मानं योगी विगतकल्मषः ।
सुखेन ब्रह्मसंस्पर्शमत्यन्तं सुखमश्नुते ॥ 28 ॥

yuñjann evaṁ sadātmānaṁ yogī vigata-kalmaṣhaḥ
sukhena brahma-sansparśham atyantam sukham aśhnute

yuñjan—uniting (the self with God); **evam**—thus; **sadā**—always; **ātmānam**—the self; **yogī**—a yogi; **vigata**—free from; **kalmaṣhaḥ**—sins; **sukhena**—easily; **brahma-sansparśham**—constantly in touch with the Supreme; **atyantam**—the highest; **sukham**—bliss; **aśhnute**—attains

Thus the yogi free from evil, practising yoga (union with Atma) always, attains easily the highest bliss resulting from contact with Brahman.

VERSE 6.29

सर्वभूतस्थमात्मानं सर्वभूतानि चात्मनि ।
ईक्षते योगयुक्तात्मा सर्वत्र समदर्शनः ॥ 29 ॥

sarva-bhūta-stham ātmānam sarva-bhūtāni chātmani
īkṣhate yoga-yuktātmā sarvatra sama-darśhanaḥ

sarva-bhūta-stham—situated in all living beings; **ātmānam**—Supreme Soul; **sarva**—all; **bhūtāni**—living beings; **cha**—and; **ātmani**—in God; **īkṣhate**—sees; **yoga-yukta-ātmā**—one united in consciousness with God; **sarvatra**—everywhere; **sama-darśhanaḥ**—equal vision

The sage harmonised in yoga sees the Self in all beings, and all beings in the Self; he sees the same everywhere.

086. Chapter 6 verses 30-32

VERSE 6.30

यो मां पश्यति सर्वत्र सर्वं च मयि पश्यति ।
तस्याहं न प्रणश्यामि स च मे न प्रणश्यति ॥ 30 ॥

yo mām paśhyati sarvatra sarvaṁ cha mayi paśhyati
tasyāhaṁ na praṇaśhyāmi sa cha me na praṇaśhyati

yaḥ—who; mām—me; paśhyati—see; sarvatra—everywhere; sarvaṁ—everything; cha—and; mayi—in me; paśhyati—see; tasya—for him; ahaṁ—I; na—not; praṇaśhyāmi—lost; saḥ—that person; cha—and; me—to me; na—nor; praṇaśhyati—lost

**He who sees Me in all beings and all beings in me never
becomes lost to me, nor do I become lost to him.**

VERSE 6.31

सर्वभूतस्थितं यो मां भजत्येकत्वमास्थितः ।
सर्वथा वर्तमानोऽपि स योगी मयि वर्तते ॥ 31 ॥

sarva-bhūta-sthitam yo mām bhajatyekatvam āsthitah
sarvathā vartamāno 'pi sa yogī mayi vartate

sarva-bhūta-sthitam—situated in all beings; **yaḥ**—who; **mām**—me; **bhajati**—worships; **ekatvam**—in unity; **āsthitah**—established; **sarvathā**—in all kinds of; **varta-mānaḥ**—remain; **api**—although; **saḥ**—he; **yogī**—a yogi; **mayi**—in me; **vartate**—dwells

The Yogi who worships Me abiding in all beings and who is established in unity abides in me in whatever manner he is acting.

VERSE 6.32

आत्मौपम्येन सर्वत्र समं पश्यति योऽर्जुन ।
सुखं वा यदि वा दुःखं स योगी परमो मतः ॥ 32 ॥

ātmaupamyena sarvatra samam paśhyati yo 'rjuna
sukham vā yadi vā duḥkham sa yogī paramo mataḥ

ātma-aupamyena—similar to oneself; sarvatra—everywhere; samam—equally; paśhyati—see; yaḥ—who; arjuna—Arjun; sukham—joy; vā—or; yadi—if; vā—or; duḥkham—sorrow; saḥ—such; yogī—a yogi; paramaḥ—highest; mataḥ—is considered

He who judges pleasure or pain everywhere, by the same standard as he applies to himself, that yogi is thought to be the highest.

087. Chapter 6 verses 33-35

VERSE 6.33

अर्जुन उवाच ।

योऽयं योगस्त्वया प्रोक्तः साम्येन मधुसूदन ।

एतस्याहं न पश्यामि चञ्चलत्वात्स्थितिं स्थिराम् ॥ 33 ॥

arjuna uvācha

yo 'yaṁ yogas tvayā proktaḥ sāmyena madhusūdana

etasyāhaṁ na paśhyāmi chañchalatvāt sthitim sthirām

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **yaḥ**—which; **ayam**—this; **yogaḥ**—system of Yog; **tvayā**—by you; **proktaḥ**—described; **sāmyena**—by equanimity; **madhu-sūdana**—Shree Krishna, the killer of the demon named Madhu; **etasya**—of this; **aham**—I; **na**—do not; **paśhyāmi**—see; **chañchalatvāt**—due to restlessness; **sthitim**—situation; **sthirām**—steady

Arjuna said: The system of Yoga that you have described and attainable by equality of mind, O Madhusudana, appears impractical and unattainable to me, due to the restless mind.

VERSE 6.34

चञ्चलं हि मनः कृष्ण प्रमाथि बलवद्दृढम् ।
तस्याहं निग्रहं मन्ये वायोरिव सुदुष्करम् ॥ 34 ॥

chañchalam hi manaḥ kṛiṣṇa pramāthi balavad dṛiḍham
tasyāham nigrahaṁ manye vāyor iva su-duṣhkaram

chañchalam—restless; **hi**—certainly; **manaḥ**—mind; **kṛiṣṇa**—Shree Krishna; **pramāthi**—turbulent; **bala-vat**—strong; **dṛiḍham**—obstinate; **tasya**—its; **aham**—I; **nigraham**—control; **manye**—think; **vāyoḥ**—of the wind; **iva**—like; **su-duṣhkaram**—difficult to perform

The mind is very restless, turbulent, strong, and obstinate, O Krishna. It appears to me that it is more difficult to control than the wind.

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

असंशयं महाबाहो मनो दुर्निग्रहं चलम् ।

अभ्यासेन तु कौन्तेय वैराग्येण च गृह्यते ॥ 35 ॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

asanśhayam mahā-bāho mano durnigrahaṁ chalam

abhyāsenā tu kaunteya vairāgyeṇa cha grīhyate

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—Lord Krishna said; **asanśhayam**—undoubtedly; **mahā-bāho**—mighty-armed one; **manaḥ**—the mind; **durnigrahaṁ**—difficult to restrain; **chalam**—restless; **abhyāsenā**—by practice; **tu**—but; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **vairāgyeṇa**—by detachment; **cha**—and; **grīhyate**—can be controlled

The Lord said: Doubtless, O mighty Arjuna, the mind is restless and hard to control; but by practice and by detachment, O son of Kunti, it can be restrained.

088. Chapter 6 verses 36-42

VERSE 6.36

असंयतात्मना योगो दुष्प्राप इति मे मतिः ।
वश्यात्मना तु यतता शक्योऽवाप्तुमुपायतः ॥ 36 ॥

asaṅyatātmanā yogo duṣhprāpa iti me matiḥ
vaśhyātmanā tu yatatā śhakyo 'vāptum upāyataḥ

asanyata-ātmanā—one whose mind is unbridled; **yogaḥ**—Yog; **duṣhprāpaḥ**—difficult to attain; **iti**—thus; **me**—my; **matiḥ**—opinion; **vaśhya-ātmanā**—by one whose mind is controlled; **tu**—but; **yatatā**—one who strives; **śhakyaḥ**—possible; **avāptum**—to achieve; **upāyataḥ**—by right means

Yoga is hard to attain by a man who cannot control his mind, but it can be attained by him who has controlled his mind and who strives earnestly by proper means. This is My opinion.

अर्जुन उवाच ।

अयतिः श्रद्धयोपेतो योगाच्चलितमानसः ।

अप्राप्य योगसंसिद्धिं कां गतिं कृष्ण गच्छति ॥ 37 ॥

arjuna uvācha

ayatiḥ śhraddhayopeto yogāch chalita-mānasah

aprāpya yoga-sansiddhim kām gatiṁ kṛiṣhṇa gachchhati

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **ayatiḥ**—lax; **śhraddhayā**—with faith; **upetaḥ**—possessed; **yogāt**—from Yog; **chalita-mānasah**—whose mind becomes deviated; **aprāpya**—failing to attain; **yoga-sansiddhim**—the highest perfection in yog; **kām**—which; **gatiṁ**—destination; **kṛiṣhṇa**—Shree Krishna; **gachchhati**—goes

Arjuna said: What is the fate of the unsuccessful yogi who begins the path with faith, but who does not endeavor sufficiently due to an unsteady mind and is unable to reach the goal of Yoga in this life?

VERSE 6.38

कच्चिन्नोभयविभ्रष्टश्छिन्नाभ्रमिव नश्यति ।
अप्रतिष्ठो महाबाहो विमूढो ब्रह्मणः पथि ॥ ३८ ॥

kachchin nobhaya-vibhraṣṭaśh chhinnābhram iva naśhyati
apraṭiṣṭho mahā-bāho vimūḍho brahmaṇaḥ pathi

kachchit—whether; **na**—not; **ubhaya**—both; **vibhraṣṭaḥ**—deviated from; **chhinna**—broken; **abhram**—cloud; **iva**—like; **naśhyati**—perishes; **apraṭiṣṭhaḥ**—without any support; **mahā-bāho**—mighty-armed Krishna; **vimūḍhaḥ**—bewildered; **brahmaṇaḥ**—of God-realization; **pathi**—one on the path

Does not such a person who deviates from Yog get deprived of both material and spiritual success, O mighty-armed Krishna, and perish like a broken cloud with no position in either sphere?

VERSE 6.39

एतन्मे संशयं कृष्ण छेत्तुमर्हस्यशेषतः ।
त्वदन्यः संशयस्यास्य छेत्ता न ह्युपपद्यते ॥ ३९ ॥

etan me sanśhayam kṛiṣṇa chhettum arhasyaśheṣhataḥ
tvad-anyaḥ sanśhayasyāsyā chhettā na hyupapadyate

etat—this; **me**—my; **sanśhayam**—doubt; **kṛiṣṇa**—Krishna; **chhettum**—to dispel; **arhasi**—you can; **aśheṣhataḥ**—completely; **tvat**—than you; **anyaḥ**—other; **sanśhayasya**—of doubt; **asya**—this; **chhettā**—a dispeller; **na**—never; **hi**—certainly; **upapadyate**—is fit

**You should completely dispel, O Krishna, this doubt of mine;
for no one but You can destroy such a doubt.**

VERSE 6.40

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

पार्थ नैवेह नामुत्र विनाशस्तस्य विद्यते ।

न हि कल्याणकृत्कश्चिद्दुर्गतिं तात गच्छति ॥ 40 ॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

pārtha naiveha nāmutra vināśhas tasya vidyate

na hi kalyāṇa-kṛit kaśhchid durgatim tāta gachchhati

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Lord said; **pārtha**—Arjun, the son of Pritha; **na eva**—never; **iha**—in this world; **na**—never; **amutra**—in the next world; **vināśhaḥ**—destruction; **tasya**—his; **vidyate**—exists; **na**—never; **hi**—certainly; **kalyāṇa-kṛit**—one who strives for God-realization; **kaśhchit**—anyone; **durgatim**—evil destination; **tāta**—my friend; **gachchhati**—goes

The Lord said: O Pārtha, there is no destruction for him either in this world or the next: no evil, My son, befalls a man who does good.

VERSE 6.41

प्राप्य पुण्यकृतां लोकानुषित्वा शाश्वतीः समाः ।
शुचीनां श्रीमतां गेहे योगभ्रष्टोऽभिजायते ॥ 41 ॥

prāpya puṇya-kṛitām lokān uṣhitvā śhāśhvatīḥ samāḥ
śhuchīnām śhrīmatām gehe yoga-bhraṣṭo 'bhijāyate

prāpya—attain; **puṇya-kṛitām**—of the virtuous; **lokān**—abodes; **uṣhitvā**—after dwelling; **śhāśhvatīḥ**—many; **samāḥ**—ages; **śhuchīnām**—of the pious; **śhrī-matām**—of the prosperous; **gehe**—in the house; **yoga-bhraṣṭaḥ**—the unsuccessful yogis; **abhijāyate**—take birth;

The man who has fallen away from yoga goes to the worlds of the righteous. Having lived there for unnumbered years, he is reborn in the home of the pure and the prosperous.

VERSE 6.42

अथवा योगिनामेव कुले भवति धीमताम् ।
एतद्धि दुर्लभतरं लोके जन्म यदीदृशम् ॥ 42 ॥

atha vā yoginām eva kule bhavati dhīmatām
etat dhi durlabhataram loke janma yad īdṛśham

atha vā—else; **yoginām**—of those endowed with divine wisdom; **eva**—certainly; **kule**—in the family; **bhavati**—take birth; **dhī-matām**—of the wise; **etat**—this; **hi**—certainly; **durlabha-taram**—very rare; **loke**—in this world; **janma**—birth; **yad**—which; **īdṛśham**—like this

Or he is born into a family of yogis rich in wisdom. Verily, such a birth is hard to gain in this world.

089. Chapter 6 verses 43-47

VERSE 6.43

तत्र तं बुद्धिसंयोगं लभते पौर्वदेहिकम् ।
यतते च ततो भूयः संसिद्धौ कुरुनन्दन ॥ 43 ॥

tatra taṁ buddhi-sanyogaṁ labhate paurva-dehikam
yatate cha tato bhūyaḥ sansiddhau kuru-nandana

tatra—there; **taṁ**—that; **buddhi-sanyogaṁ**—reawaken their wisdom; **labhate**—obtains; **paurva-dehikam**—from the previous lives; **yatate**—strives; **cha**—and; **tataḥ**—thereafter; **bhūyaḥ**—again; **sansiddhau**—for perfection; **kuru-nandana**—Arjun, descendant of the Kurus

There he comes in touch with the knowledge acquired in his former body, O son of the Kurus, and strives still further for perfection.

VERSE 6.44

पूर्वाभ्यासेन तेनैव ह्रियते ह्यवशोऽपि सः ।
जिज्ञासुरपि योगस्य शब्दब्रह्मातिवर्तते ॥ 44 ॥

pūrvābhyāsenā tenaiva hriyate hyavaśho 'pi saḥ
jijñāsur api yogasya śhabda-brahmātivartate

pūrva—past; **abhyāsenā**—discipline; **tena**—by that; **eva**—certainly; **hriyate**—is attracted; **hi**—surely; **avaśhaḥ**—helplessly; **api**—although; **saḥ**—that person; **jijñāsuḥ**—inquisitive; **api**—even; **yogasya**—about yog; **śhabda-brahma**—fruitive portion of the Vedas; **ativartate**—transcends

Indeed, they feel drawn toward God, even against their will, on the strength of their past discipline. Such seekers naturally rise above the ritualistic principles of the scriptures.

VERSE 6.45

प्रयत्नाद्यतमानस्तु योगी संशुद्धकिल्बिषः ।
अनेकजन्मसंसिद्धस्ततो याति परां गतिम् ॥ 45 ॥

prayatnād yatamānas tu yogī sanśhuddha-kilbiṣhaḥ
aneka-janma-sansiddhas tato yāti parām gatim

prayatnāt—with great effort; **yatamānaḥ**—endeavoring; **tu**—and; **yogī**—a yogi; **sanśhuddha**—purified; **kilbiṣhaḥ**—from material desires; **aneka**—after many, many; **janma**—births; **sansiddhaḥ**—attain perfection; **tataḥ**—then; **yāti**—attains; **parām**—the highest; **gatim**—path

Practising assiduously, the yogi having acquired perfection through many births attains the supreme state (Moksha) purified of all sins.

VERSE 6.46

तपस्विभ्योऽधिकोयोगी
ज्ञानिभ्योऽपिमतोऽधिकः।
कर्मिभ्यश्चाधिकोयोगी
तस्माद्योगीभवार्जुन ॥ 46 ॥

tapasvibhyo 'dhiko yogī
jñānibhyo 'pi mato 'dhikaḥ
karmibhyaśh chādhiko yogī
tasmād yogī bhavārjuna

tapasvibhyaḥ—than the ascetics; **adhikaḥ**—superior; **yogī**—a yogi; **jñānibhyaḥ**—than the persons of learning; **api**—even; **mataḥ**—considered; **adhikaḥ**—superior; **karmibhyaḥ**—than the ritualistic performers; **cha**—and; **adhikaḥ**—superior; **yogī**—a yogi; **tasmāt**—therefore; **yogī**—a yogi; **bhava**—just become; **arjuna**—Arjun

O Arjuna! The yogi is thought to be greater than the ascetic, greater than the learned, and greater than the man of action; therefore be a yogi.

VERSE 6.47

योगिनामपि सर्वेषां मद्गतेनान्तरात्मना ।

श्रद्धावान्भजते यो मां स मे युक्ततमो मतः ॥ 47 ॥

yoginām api sarveṣhām mad-gatenāntar-ātmanā

śhraddhāvān bhajate yo mām sa me yuktatamo mataḥ

yoginām—of all yogis; **api**—however; **sarveṣhām**—all types of; **mat-gatena**—absorbed in me (God); **antaḥ**—inner; **ātmanā**—with the mind; **śhraddhā-vān**—with great faith; **bhajate**—engage in devotion; **yaḥ**—who; **mām**—to me; **saḥ**—he; **me**—by me; **yukta-tamaḥ**—the highest yogi; **mataḥ**—is considered

Even among yogis, he who worships Me with mind fixed in Me, full of faith, is deemed by me to be the most devout.